



BEERAN'S
OUTLOOK TOOLS

Beeran's Outlook Tools

User Manual

Version 2.1

Direct, powerful control over Microsoft Outlook — no cloud accounts, no Azure registrations, no subscriptions.

Table of Contents

Table of Contents	2
1. Welcome	4
Requirements	4
2. Getting Started	5
First Launch	5
Navigating the App	5
3. Inbox	6
3.1 Monitor	6
3.2 Follow-up Tracker	6
3.3 Bulk Archive	6
3.4 Account Archive	6
3.5 Rules	7
3.6 Search	8
4. Compose	9
4.1 Templates	9
4.2 Out of Office	9
4.3 Signatures	9
5. Cleanup Email	10
5.1 Bulk Email	10
5.2 Duplicate Emails	10
5.3 Email Size	10
6. Contacts	11
6.1 Duplicate Contacts	11
6.2 Export / Import	11
7. Calendar	12

7.1 Daily Digest	12
7.2 Duplicate Calendar	12
7.3 Calendar Backup	12
7.4 Meeting Inspector	13
8. Utilities	15
8.1 Attachments	15
8.2 Export to PDF	15
8.3 Folder Statistics	15
8.4 Log	15
8.5 Schedule	15
9. Settings & About	16
Outlook Connection Status	16
Diagnostics	16
Accounts	16
Add-ins	17
System	18
10. System Tray	18
11. Security	18
12. Troubleshooting	19
13. Version History	21
14. License & Support	22
Support & Suggestions	22

1. Welcome

Beeran's Outlook Tools is a Windows desktop app that connects directly to Microsoft Outlook over MAPI/COM. There's no Azure app registration, no API keys, and no browser sign-in — it talks straight to the same Outlook already running on your machine.

This manual covers all 28 features across the app's six navigation groups: **Inbox**, **Compose**, **Cleanup Email**, **Contacts**, **Calendar**, and **Utilities** — plus Settings, About, and the system tray.

New in this version: **Account Archive** (Inbox), and **Calendar Backup** and **Meeting Inspector** (Calendar). Look for the “New in v2.1” tag on those sections.

Requirements

Operating system	Windows 10 or 11
Microsoft Outlook	Installed and running on the same machine
Internet access	Only needed for Bulk Email's Auto-Unsubscribe feature
Account types	Exchange / Microsoft 365 for full functionality; IMAP/POP3 accounts work for most features, with a few exceptions noted per feature below (e.g. Out of Office)

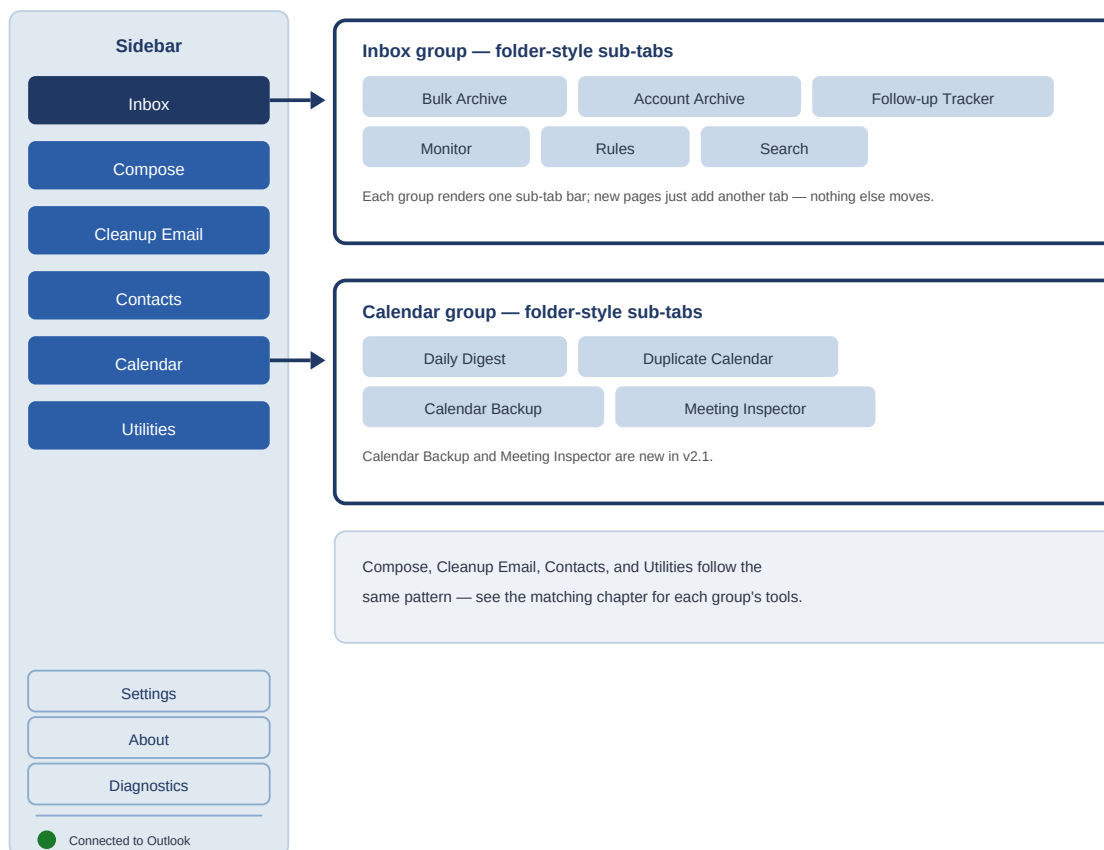
2. Getting Started

First Launch

- Open **Microsoft Outlook** first — the app connects to whichever Outlook profile is already running.
- Launch **Beeran's Outlook Tools.exe**. It lands on a Welcome screen.
- The app automatically discovers every account and folder in your Outlook profile — this can take a few seconds on large mailboxes.
- Pick a group from the sidebar on the left to get started. Settings save automatically as you work.

Navigating the App

The sidebar has six grouped sections. Each group opens a row of folder-style sub-tabs across the top of the content area — clicking a tab swaps the page below it without leaving the group. Settings, About, and Diagnostics are pinned at the bottom of the sidebar and are not part of any group, with a live Outlook connection indicator beneath them.



The grouped sidebar navigation, showing the Inbox and Calendar groups' sub-tabs as an example.

The chapters that follow are organized the same way — one chapter per sidebar group, one section per sub-tab.

3. Inbox

Watch folders, track unanswered mail, clean up old email, archive an entire account, search, and manage native Outlook rules.

3.1 Monitor

Watches up to 4 Outlook folders at once, each with its own independent alert settings. If a watched folder goes quiet for longer than its threshold, the app fires an alert.

Account / Folder	Which mailbox and folder to watch
Alert if no mail for	Minutes of silence before an alert fires
Alert sound	20 built-in sounds, a Windows system sound, or a custom .wav
Repeat alert	Repeat the sound + popup every 1–5 minutes until mail arrives

Tip: Alerts use a real, dismissable popup window (not the Windows toast), so you can read the full message and select its text.

3.2 Follow-up Tracker

Scans Sent Items for messages that haven't received a reply after a configurable number of days, matching replies by conversation topic. Results export to .csv, and scans can run on a schedule (interval or daily at a set time).

Matching is best-effort — unusual threading across different mail clients can occasionally produce a false positive.

3.3 Bulk Archive

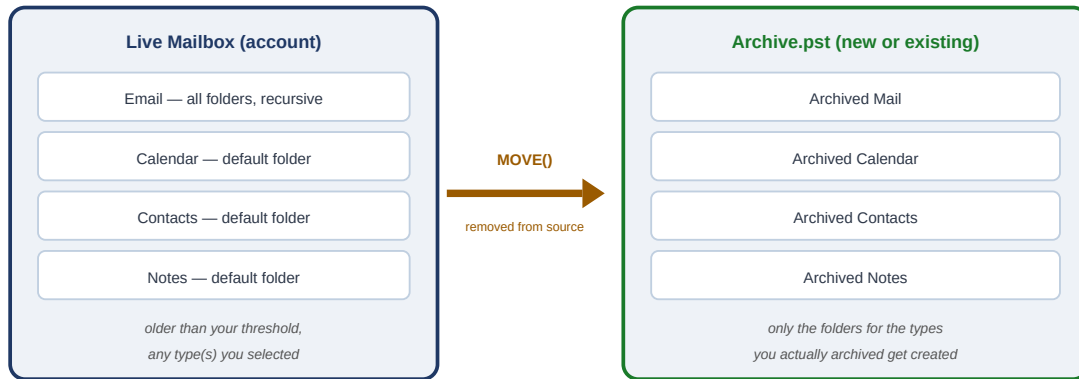
Moves or deletes many emails at once from a single folder, filtered by age (and optionally unread-only). A count preview always appears before anything happens.

Source folder	The one folder this scan targets
Action	Move to another Outlook folder, or Delete
Older than	Age threshold in days

3.4 Account Archive

New in v2.1

Moves old items out of an **entire account** into a separate .pst archive file — this actually frees up mailbox space, the same way Outlook's own built-in Archive works. Unlike Bulk Archive above (one folder, email only), Account Archive can sweep Email, Calendar, Contacts, and Notes in a single pass, with one age threshold for everything.



Always preceded by Scan → per-type count preview → Confirm Archive review window.

Account Archive moves matched items out of the live mailbox into a new-or-existing .pst — always behind a Scan-then-Confirm review step.

How to use it

- Pick the **account** to archive — there's no folder picker here, since it works across the whole account.
- Check any combination of **Email, Calendar, Contacts, Notes**.
- Set the age threshold — one number applies to every checked type.
- Choose **Create new archive file** or **Add to an existing archive file** (the existing file just keeps growing across runs).
- Click **Scan**. A per-type count preview opens in a review window — uncheck any type you don't want archived this run, then click **Confirm Archive**.

Important: Calendar items that belong to an ongoing recurring series (no end date, or an end date in the future) are always skipped, even if older than your threshold — archiving would otherwise remove part of a meeting series you're still using.

Note: This is destructive by design — matched items are moved (not copied) out of their original folders. Use Calendar Backup instead if you want a copy that leaves the original untouched.

3.5 Rules

A native Outlook Rules Manager — import, edit, create, and push rules directly back to Outlook. Rules saved here keep running in Outlook even when this app is closed.

- Select an account and click **Get Rules from Outlook**.

- Toggle rules on/off, delete unwanted ones, or add/edit rules.
- Click **Send to Outlook** — the entire remaining rule list is written back and saved; you don't need to select rules first.

If something goes wrong: If saving fails because a rule has an invalid condition or a missing target folder, the app identifies exactly which rules are the problem, shows the reason for each, and offers to remove the bad ones so the save can proceed.

3.6 Search

Full-text search across Subject, Sender, and Body — scoped to one folder or an entire account, with timestamped results and a Stop button for long searches.

4. Compose

Reusable email templates, automatic out-of-office replies, and signature management.

4.1 Templates

Save frequently-used email templates (name, subject, body). Opening a template pre-fills a new Outlook compose window with one click, with a signature picker built in.

4.2 Out of Office

Reads and writes your Exchange/Microsoft 365 auto-reply settings directly — internal and external messages, optional start/end dates, and an external audience control (all senders, or contacts only). Settings are sent straight to Outlook, so the app does not need to stay open for OOF to keep working.

Requires an Exchange or Microsoft 365 account. IMAP/POP3 accounts show a warning — Outlook COM doesn't expose OOF for those account types.

4.3 Signatures

A launcher, not a WYSIWYG editor — Outlook signatures are Word-generated HTML with table layouts that a simple text editor can't reproduce faithfully. This page lists your existing signatures, previews them exactly as they'll render (images included), and opens them in Word for actual editing.

5. Cleanup Email

Detect bulk mail, find duplicate messages, and analyze mailbox size.

5.1 Bulk Email

Two ways to find bulk senders:

- **Auto-detect** — flags a sender once they've been seen at least N times (configurable), or if their mail carries a List-Unsubscribe header. External senders only, by default.
- **Manual search** — From and/or Subject contains text you specify.

Action on matches	Log only / Flag / Move to folder / Delete
Excluded Domains	Domains that are never flagged, added via text entry or one click from scan results
Auto-Unsubscribe	One-click method where supported; opens a pre-filled Outlook draft for email-based unsubscribes

5.2 Duplicate Emails

Finds duplicate messages using configurable match criteria — Subject+Sender+Date, Subject+Sender, or a custom combination of Subject/Sender/Date/Body. Actions: Log only, Flag, Delete, or Export. Scans can run on a schedule.

5.3 Email Size

Lists the largest emails in a folder by size, to help you find what's actually consuming mailbox space.

6. Contacts

Find and merge duplicate contacts; export or import via CSV.

6.1 Duplicate Contacts

Finds duplicates two ways — same name with different emails, and same email with different names.

- **Delete review** — every group listed with checkboxes (pre-checked for duplicates, keeper unchecked); nothing changes until you confirm.
- **Merge review** — choose a strategy per group: Most recently modified, Most complete, or Manual field-by-field with a live preview.

6.2 Export / Import

Exports contacts to .csv with selectable fields (Select All / Deselect All). Imports contacts from a .csv into any Contacts folder.

7. Calendar

Daily mail digest, duplicate meeting detection, calendar backup, and a diagnostic tool for meetings that won't stay deleted.

7.1 Daily Digest

Pick an account and folders to get unread counts, top senders, and sample subjects for each. Runs on demand, or as a daily popup at a set time.

7.2 Duplicate Calendar

Detects duplicate meetings two ways:

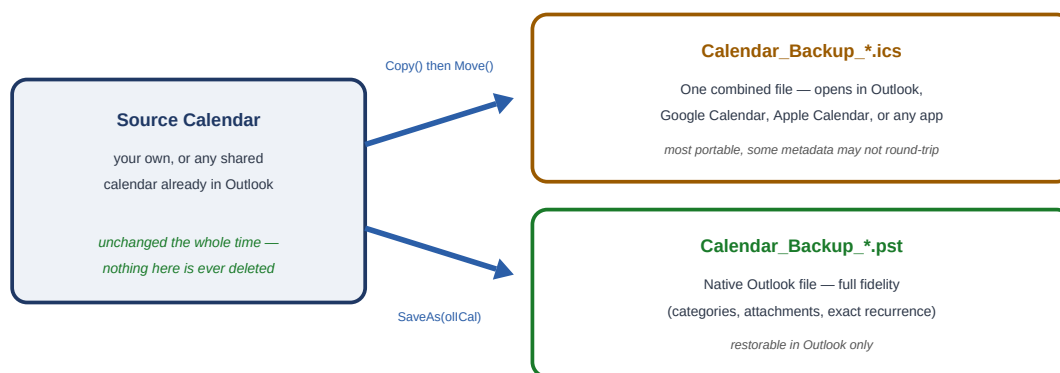
- **Individual occurrences** — finds duplicate instances within a configurable date range.
- **Recurring series** — compares entire series masters; choose whether to keep the older or newer master.

Deleting a master in series mode removes every past and future occurrence in that series. A review window always opens first.

7.3 Calendar Backup

New in v2.1

Exports a calendar to .ics and/or a standalone .pst file — a non-destructive copy; nothing is ever removed from the original calendar. Works on your own calendar or any shared calendar already visible in your Outlook profile.



Calendar Backup can produce both output formats from the same run — the source calendar is only ever read from, never modified.

Scope

- **Entire calendar** — exports each recurring series once, as its master record with the recurrence pattern intact. Recommended for a full backup.
- **Date range** — expands recurring meetings into the individual occurrences that actually fall inside the window, which is closer to “what’s on the calendar between these two dates.”

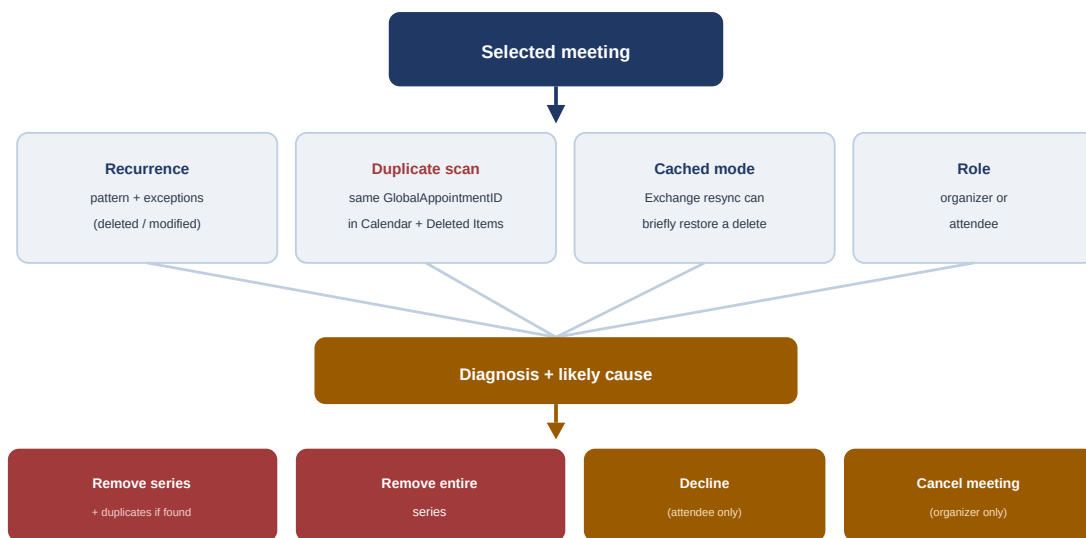
Output format

- **.ics** — one combined file, opens in Outlook, Google Calendar, Apple Calendar, or any calendar app. Most portable; some Outlook-specific metadata may not round-trip perfectly.
- **.pst** — a native Outlook data file, full fidelity (categories, attachments, exact recurrence). Restorable in Outlook only.

7.4 Meeting Inspector

New in v2.1

Diagnoses why a meeting keeps reappearing after you delete it, then helps you remove it the right way instead of guessing. This is the tool to reach for when a meeting comes back within minutes of deleting it, with no new invite email — that pattern usually means a duplicate copy or a sync quirk, not anything you did wrong.



Only the actions that fit what was found are shown — each requires a confirmation step.

Meeting Inspector runs four checks, then only offers the actions that fit what it actually found.

How to use it

- Pick an account and calendar folder, then type part of the meeting’s subject and click **Find**.
- Click **Inspect** on the match you mean. The Diagnosis panel fills in with the recurrence pattern, any exceptions, a duplicate-copy check, Cached Exchange Mode status, and whether you’re the organizer or an attendee.
- Choose from the action buttons that appear below the diagnosis — only the ones that make sense for that meeting are shown.

What each check means

Recurrence pattern	Frequency, interval, end date, and how many exceptions (deleted or modified occurrences) exist on the series
Duplicate scan	Looks for another item with the same GlobalAppointmentID in the calendar and in Deleted Items — the direct explanation for “I deleted it and it came right back”
Cached Exchange Mode	If your mailbox is cached, a background resync can briefly re-show an item before the delete finishes syncing to the server
Organizer / Attendee	Determines whether Decline (attendee) or Cancel (organizer) is offered — deleting your own copy of someone else's meeting doesn't stop them resending it

Available actions

- **Remove series + duplicates** — shown only when a duplicate was found; removes the series and every duplicate copy detected.
- **Remove entire series** — deletes the master and every occurrence, past and future.
- **Decline meeting** — attendees only. Notifies the organizer, which is what actually prevents the meeting from being resent to you.
- **Cancel meeting** — organizers only. Notifies every attendee before removing it.

Note: Every action here is permanent once confirmed. A confirmation step always appears first, describing exactly what will be removed.

8. Utilities

Extract attachments, export emails to PDF, analyze folder statistics, review the event log, and schedule automation.

8.1 Attachments

Extracts attachments from any Outlook folder to a local path or another Outlook folder, with an option to move processed emails afterward. Attachments are saved into sub-folders named after each email's subject.

8.2 Export to PDF

Exports individual emails or entire folders to PDF — one PDF per email.

Scope	All emails in folder, or a date range (calendar picker included)
Additional filter	Subject or From contains text — applies regardless of scope, with a red “Filter Active” badge when set
Options	List attachment names, save attachments to a subfolder, choose filename format, open the output folder when done

8.3 Folder Statistics

An at-a-glance summary of any folder: total emails, unread count and percentage, total size in MB, oldest/newest email dates, and date span. Walks subfolders recursively, with Exchange cached-mode detection so you know whether the count reflects everything on the server or just what's cached locally.

8.4 Log

A live, timestamped record of every event — monitor checks, alerts, extractions, rule actions, scans, and errors. Exportable to .txt or .csv.

8.5 Schedule

Runs attachment extraction automatically on an interval and/or daily at a set time, using the same source/destination settings as the Attachments tab.

9. Settings & About

Appearance	Dark, Light (default), or System
On window close	Auto (default — asks only if Monitor is active), Ask, Tray, or Exit
Portable Version	Off (default), or On — deletes config.json when the app closes, so running this app from a USB drive or shared folder on a different computer never inherits the previous computer's accounts, folders, or settings.

The About page shows the full feature list, version number, third-party library attributions, and the complete proprietary license text — and includes a suggestion box that emails the developer directly.

Outlook Connection Status

New in v2.1 — A small dot and status label sit at the bottom of the sidebar, just below Settings, About, and Diagnostics, showing whether the app is currently talking to Outlook.

● Green — “Connected to Outlook”	Outlook is running and reachable; every tool is available.
● Red — “Outlook not running”	Outlook isn't currently running, or has closed — features that need Outlook will not work until it's open again.

Auto-reconnect: The app checks Outlook's status automatically every few seconds — you never need to click anything or restart the app. If Outlook isn't running when the app starts, or closes while the app is open, the dot turns red, a note is written to the Log tab, and (if Outlook closes mid-session) a Windows notification lets you know. As soon as Outlook is running again, the dot turns green on its own and the app automatically refreshes its list of accounts and folders — no restart needed either way.

Diagnostics

New in v2.1 — The connection light only proves Outlook itself is running; it says nothing about whether one specific account's data is actually loading. A corrupted local cache (.ost) or a stuck sync can leave an account showing “connected” while its folders never populate. Diagnostics (bottom of the sidebar, next to Settings and About) checks every account directly and tells you exactly what's wrong.

Diagnostics is split into three sub-tabs — **Accounts**, **Add-ins**, and **System** — each checking a different layer of what can go wrong.

Accounts

It checks the same set of accounts shown on every other page's account dropdown — including any shared mailboxes or public folders you've been given access to, not just your own accounts. Results are grouped

under two headings, **Configured Accounts** and **Shared / Delegated Accounts**, so it's obvious at a glance which is which.

Click **Run Diagnostic** and the app checks each account's ability to actually enumerate its own folders (with an 8-second timeout per account, so one stuck account can't freeze the check), along with its Cached Exchange Mode status and the health of its local data file. Each account is marked OK, Warning, or Failed, with the specific reason and — for local data files — the exact file path. Where available, each card also shows a **Send/Receive Activity** summary (how long since each Send/Receive group last synced), a **mailbox quota** reading on Exchange/Microsoft 365 accounts once it's within 90% of full, and a warning if the account's data file lives inside a OneDrive/Dropbox/Google Drive/iCloud-synced folder — Microsoft advises against this, since the sync client can lock or partially write the file while Outlook has it open.

Close Outlook & Repair	Offered only for server-backed accounts (Exchange cached mode, or an IMAP .ost) — closes Outlook, renames the local cache so Outlook rebuilds it fresh from the server, then reopens Outlook automatically. Closing and renaming takes up to about 30 seconds, with live progress shown on the Diagnostics tab; the resync afterward is separate and can take much longer on a large mailbox. Not offered for a plain .pst, since that file is the only copy of that data.
Point to a backup file...	Browse to any .pst and mount it as a stand-in Outlook data source, so you have working data while the live account gets fixed. You choose each time whether the mount stays permanently or is removed automatically when the app closes.

If automated repair doesn't work: If Close Outlook & Repair can't finish — Outlook won't close, or the cache file stays locked — a popup walks you through what to try next: confirm Outlook is fully closed (check Task Manager) and retry, run the Inbox Repair Tool (SCANPST.EXE) on the file, or remove and re-add the account in Outlook's Account Settings. The same popup reminds you that Point to a backup file... is there in the meantime.

Diagnostics can't repair server-side Microsoft 365 issues, and closing/renaming only clears out the local cache — anything that existed solely in that file and never finished syncing to the server (an unsent draft, for example) could be lost, so the confirmation step calls that out before anything happens.

Add-ins

Lists every COM add-in registered in Outlook, whether it's currently loaded, and its startup setting (loads at startup, loads on demand, or disabled). A misbehaving add-in is a common cause of a slow, hanging, or oddly-behaving Outlook session even when every account above checks out fine.

Enable / Disable	Toggling an add-in unloads or reloads it immediately in the running Outlook session and updates its startup setting in the registry, matching Outlook's own File > Options > Add-ins dialog. If a disabled add-in re-enables itself after a restart, an organization IT policy is likely re-enforcing it and it can't be controlled from here.
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Crash alert	A banner appears if Outlook has recently auto-disabled an add-in after it crashed — a likely explanation for any add-in below unexpectedly showing “Not loaded.”
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System

Two machine-level checks that commonly explain Outlook trouble which has nothing to do with any specific account:

Duplicate Outlook processes	Flags more than one OUTLOOK.EXE process running at once — a leftover process from a previous crash can lock data files and cause exactly the kind of “connected but broken” behavior Diagnostics exists to catch.
Disk space	Checks free space on every drive that hosts an account's local data file, and warns when a drive is low — cache growth failures and corruption both become more likely as free space runs out.

10. System Tray

Closing the main window asks what to do, based on the Settings page above.

Minimize to Tray	Window hides; monitoring and scheduling keep running
Exit	App shuts down completely

Double-click the tray icon, or click Show, to restore the window; Quit exits fully.

11. Security

The compiled executable includes tamper/decompilation detection. If the app detects it's being run outside its compiled environment, a full-screen warning displays the machine name, IP address, and timestamp before terminating. Reverse-engineering or decompiling this software is prohibited under the license agreement (see Section 13).

12. Troubleshooting

“Cannot connect to Outlook”

Open Outlook before launching this app. If Outlook just opened, wait a few seconds and try again.

Folders not populating in the dropdowns

Check the Log tab — any connection errors appear there with details.

pywin32 errors during build

build.bat runs the post-install step automatically. If issues persist, run manually: `python Scripts\pywin32_postinstall.py -install`

Tray icon not appearing

Make sure Pillow and pystray are installed: `pip install Pillow pystray`

Out of Office not working

OOF requires an Exchange or Microsoft 365 account. IMAP/POP3 accounts don't support Out of Office via Outlook COM — the app shows a warning on that page if your account type isn't compatible.

Rules “invalid actions or conditions” error on save

One or more existing Outlook rules may have a missing target folder or invalid condition. The app identifies the specific rules and offers to remove them automatically so the save can proceed.

Bulk Email auto-detect not flagging anything

On personal accounts, the app may not detect your “own domain” automatically — check the Log tab for a note. Frequency-based and List-Unsubscribe detection still work; double-check your Excluded Domains list isn't covering senders you expected to see.

Auto-Unsubscribe not working for a sender

Some senders only support unsubscribing by email reply. The app opens a pre-filled Outlook draft rather than failing silently — check the results list for a [unsubscribe via email] tag.

A meeting keeps coming back after I delete it

Use the Meeting Inspector (Calendar group) instead of deleting it again — it will tell you whether this is a duplicate copy, a cached-mode resync, or an attendee/organizer mismatch, and offer the action that actually fixes it.

Account Archive says an account isn't found

The account name must match exactly what Outlook shows for that store. Re-open the page to refresh the account dropdown if you've recently added or removed an account in Outlook.

The dot below About is red

The app can't currently reach Outlook — usually because Outlook isn't open, or just closed. Open (or reopen) Outlook and wait a few seconds; the dot turns green and the app reconnects automatically, with no restart needed.

The dot is green, but one account's folders won't populate

That green light only confirms Outlook itself is running — it doesn't check any individual account. Open Diagnostics (bottom of the sidebar) and click Run Diagnostic; it will identify the broken account, explain the likely cause (usually a corrupted .ost or a stuck sync), and point you at the exact file and fix. You can also mount a backup .pst from there to keep working meanwhile.

A disabled add-in turns itself back on

Check the Add-ins sub-tab under Diagnostics. If it re-enables after an Outlook restart, your organization's IT policy is likely managing that add-in centrally — it can't be permanently disabled from a per-user setting in that case.

Diagnostics flags low disk space or a near-full mailbox

Both are shown on the Diagnostics tab (System and Accounts sub-tabs) before they cause real symptoms. Free up space on the flagged drive, or ask your admin about a mailbox quota increase or an archive/cleanup pass, before the account starts failing to sync.

13. Version History

v2.1	Calendar Backup (.ics / .pst export, non-destructive) · Meeting Inspector (duplicate-copy and recurrence diagnostics) · Account Archive (whole-account, multi-type, moves to a new-or-existing .pst) · Outlook connection status indicator with automatic reconnect · Diagnostics, now with Accounts / Add-ins / System sub-tabs — per-account health check with mailbox quota, Send/Receive activity, and cloud-sync data-file warnings, one-click repair for server-backed accounts, backup-file mount, COM add-in list with enable/disable, and system-level checks for duplicate Outlook processes and low disk space · Portable Version setting
v2.0	Native Outlook Rules Manager · Email Templates · Out of Office Manager · Bulk Archive · Email Size Analyzer · Folder Statistics · Contact Export/Import · Duplicate Calendar Detector · Grouped navigation · 20 built-in alert sounds · Tamper detection
v1.5	Follow-up Tracker · Daily Digest · Duplicate Email Detector · Duplicate Contact Detector · Bulk Email Detector with auto-unsubscribe · Welcome landing page
v1.4	4 built-in musical alert sounds · Per-folder repeat alerts
v1.3	Multi-folder monitor (up to 4) · Per-folder custom sounds · About page · Light mode default
v1.2	System tray · Scheduled extraction · Email rules engine · Full-text search · Log export · Dark/light themes
v1.0	Inbox monitor · Attachment extractor · In-app log · Windows notifications

14. License & Support

Beeran's Outlook Tools is proprietary software — free to use, but may not be modified or redistributed. Attempting to reverse-engineer or decompile the application is prohibited under the license agreement. The complete license text is in LICENSE.md and on the About page inside the app.

Support & Suggestions

Use the About tab inside the app to send a suggestion directly, or email **BeeransTools@outlook.com**. This app grows with its users — if there's a feature, a folder action, or anything else on your mind, it's worth sending.

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